

Cafe Barra Strategy Document

Internal Leadership Framework | March 2026

Purpose

This is the source of truth for strategic decisions. Not external messaging. Not sales copy. The blueprint for how we win.

Winning Aspiration

Be the most trusted brand-building coffee partner for independent cafes that care about their story.

We don't want to be the biggest wholesale roaster. We want to be the one that matters most to the right partners.

Where to Play

Brand-led B2B model. Quality-conscious independent cafes and specialty venues.

Specific inclusion criteria:

- Local brand ambition (they're building something)
- Owner-led culture (someone gives a damn)
- Staff willing to train (they'll do the work)
- Sufficient volume to sustain relationship (define threshold internally)
- Story-oriented mindset (price isn't their only lever)

Explicit exclusions:

- Volume-first buyers where price is primary decision factor
- High staff turnover with no training commitment
- Locked into national branded supplier with no differentiation desire
- Owner absent, no on-site quality advocate

Supporting channel: DTC as signal and social proof. Not primary growth focus.

How to Win

Three pillars. All three required.

1. The Barra Roast Method

Proprietary, codified roasting process grounded in systematic experimentation per bean. Science meets art meets commitment. This turns founder expertise from bottleneck into transferable capability.

2. Curated Partner Network

Selectivity creates desirability. Partners don't just buy coffee. They earn a seat. That scarcity is the differentiator.

3. Last Mile Excellence

Named standard for how coffee gets prepared at partner locations. Not a philosophy. A system with training, compliance tracking, quality checks.

Core Capabilities

Capability	Importance	Action
Barra Roast Method	Critical	Codify now. Document experiments. Name it. Use in sales.
Ideal Partner Selection	Critical	Build hard-edged Partner Fit Profile. Score every prospect.
Brand Narrative Crafting	Critical	Tighten manifesto. Cut inflation. Increase precision.
Last Mile Excellence Protocol	High	Create named standard. Train to it. Track compliance.
Operational Scalability	High	Get founder's knowledge out of head. Document. Delegate.

Explicit Tradeoffs

Real strategy requires saying no.

We will not:

- Accept partners who can't execute to our quality standards
- Compete on price with commodity suppliers
- Grow faster than we can maintain quality
- Dilute the brand for volume
- Let founder time get consumed by low-leverage operational tasks
- Chase every account that shows interest

We choose:

- Fewer, better partners over maximum account count
- Higher margins over higher volume
- Repeatable systems over heroic individual effort
- Proof-driven growth over opportunistic expansion
- Partner success over fast scaling

12-Month Priorities

In order. Do not skip ahead.

Q1-Q2:

- Codify Barra Roast Method (full documentation package)
- Build Ideal Partner Profile scoring system
- Create Last Mile Excellence Standard and training materials
- Separate the four document types (this strategy doc, positioning architecture, sales narrative, brand manifesto)

Q2-Q3:

- Establish proof tracking system for next cohort of partners
- Onboard 3-5 high-fit accounts with full method applied
- Capture structured case evidence

Q3-Q4:

- Refine method based on learning
- Build repeatable evidence engine
- Selective scale only when ready

Management Systems

Monthly Leadership Scorecard:

Commercial:

- Target-fit partner conversations
- Target-fit conversion rate
- Average account value
- Gross margin by channel
- Retention and churn

Operational:

- Onboarding cycle time
- Training completion rate
- Quality incident rate
- Founder time in low-leverage tasks (track to reduce)

Brand and Partner Strength:

- Partner satisfaction (quarterly structured check)

- Partner advocacy/referrals
- Reorder growth per account
- Quality of testimonials from ideal-fit partners

Quarterly Partner Review Cadence:

- Quality compliance check
- Satisfaction survey
- Story usage review
- Account health assessment

Brand Governance:

Monthly review of brand-related activities against core strategy.

Success Metrics

Leadership judges progress by these tests:

- Are we winning the right accounts (not just any accounts)?
- Are partners staying and growing with us?
- Is founder time shifting to high-leverage activities?
- Is quality holding as we scale?
- Are we building proof that sells the next partner?
- Can we explain our method to someone who isn't Scott?

If the answer to any of these is no, stop and fix it before moving forward.